since the last days of Stalin. Only Kosygin made it to the second place, (c) The Moscow group, of which Grishen and Andropov, the KGB chief, are the most important, (d) Senior members from the other parts of the union will play a role only in a fairly equal power struggle. Speculations about the army taking over power are unjustified, unless something of truly catastrophic proportions happens to the economy. Parallels from China and Yugoslavia are irrelevant in a country which was originally founded by political parties and not by the army. The recent Polish parallel has a little more significance. Bonapartism is, however, a dirty word in the Soviet Union.

The USA on the other hand was concerned about growing Soviet influence in India, which it believed undermined its own interests. The CIA argued that the India-Soviet relationship had strengthened over the years for primarily four reasons. First reason was the Soviet support for India during the 1965 war with Pakistan, the creation of Bangladesh, and its total support to Indira Gandhi during the Emergency. Second, the USSR was a reliable partner to India, providing sophisticated weapons at concessional rates even during wartime. Third, the Soviet Union was not only India's largest trading partner but also responded quickly to any aid requests. And finally, the Soviet Union gave unconditional support to India in international bodies like the United Nations and agreed with India's independent foreign policy. A CIA report said:

Indian receptivity to Soviet initiatives has been reinforced by Indo-US discord over Washington's support for Pakistan in the 1965 and 1971 wars, its provision of a large amount of weapons to Pakistan, and its presumed failure to restrain Pakistan's nuclear weapons programme.